TARGET LOCKED

AISHWARY PRATAP SINGH TOMAR, 20

Shooter, Ratanpur, **Madhya Pradesh**

"Aishwary clearly has the mindset of a champion. He has shown the ability to withstand pressure, which is essential in a sport like shooting. He has a long career ahead of him, hopefully interspersed with medal wins for India"

YASHODHARA RAJE SCINDIA
Minister for Sports and Youth Welfare, Madhya Pradesh

Aishwary caught the shooting bug early in life, at his family's farm in Ratanpur village in Madhya Pradesh. His cousin Navdeep introduced him to competitive shooting i 2015. Aishwary began competing in the 10-metre air rifle category, but moved to the 50-metre 0.22 three position (standing, kneeling, prone) event in 2018. Within a couple of years, he had earned a berth for himself in the Indian contingent to the Olympics. He was ranked #21 in Tokyo, but did not let the set back weaken his drive—in October this year, he won a gold at the ISSF Junior World Championships in Lima, setting a world record in the process. "The Olympics is the biggest sporting event in the world, and in Tokyo, I was competing for the first time. There were things that did not go my way, but I have the 2024 Olympics in my sights," he says. Before then, Aishwary has another chance to prove himself at the 2022 Asian Games. ■

– Rahul Noronha

BIKER BOY A bike enthusiast, Aishwary bought himself an Enfield Continental GT after the Olympics. His dream bike is a Kawasaki Ninja H2R



SANJEEV VERMA/GETTY IMAGES